

One Image, Many Readings Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 30-40 min

Category	The Arts	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	one-image-many-readings

Big idea: Evidence in interpretation is plural.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students practise evidence-based interpretation from multiple lenses.

Student Prompt

Inspect One Image, Many Readings Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

One Image, Many Readings Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: One ambiguous image interpreted through personal, cultural, political, and formal lenses. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
One Image, Many Readings Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A gallery walk where each group leaves a different reading. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
One Image, Many Readings Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A claim-evidence-context triangle for art interpretation. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Evidence in interpretation is plural.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting One Image, Many Readings Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from One Image, Many Readings Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Is ambiguity a weakness or strength in the arts?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how evidence in interpretation is plural.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Is ambiguity a weakness or strength in the arts?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: One ambiguous image interpreted through personal, cultural, political, and formal lenses.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- One ambiguous image interpreted through personal, cultural, political, and formal lenses.
- A gallery walk where each group leaves a different reading.
- A claim-evidence-context triangle for art interpretation.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/one-image-many-readings/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/one-image-many-readings/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/one-image-many-readings/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Assign lenses: emotional, political, historical, technical, feminist, religious, personal, formal composition.
2. Groups produce a reading using at least three pieces of evidence from the work.
3. Groups compare compatible and incompatible interpretations.
4. Create class criteria for a strong interpretation.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Is ambiguity a weakness or strength in the arts?
- What counts as evidence in artistic interpretation?
- Can art reveal truths that cannot be stated directly?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...